

DEMOCRACY MATTERS * DAY8

Democracy Matters

Today's Special Topic: Separation of Powers

TODAY +★



Civics & Basic Concepts



Communication & Social Media



Action & Mobilisation



1 • Special Topic

Separation of powers — the sprint

30'

2 • Die Runde

Discussion & wind-down

The Learning Loop — Learn it. Keep it. • 3★ per pillar → DM Champion • 6★ → DM Master

SPECIAL TOPIC

Separation of Powers

Why power needs checks — Swiss edition

Warm-up

5'

Topic

10'

Exercise

5'

Take-away

5'

Why this topic? Separation of powers is the basic blueprint of every democracy — and under pressure worldwide. If you know the blueprint, you notice when someone saws at it.

Sprint

30m

1 — WARM-UP

Phones out



Scan the QR, enter a name — three questions, everyone at once.

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz

Join — if the QR code acts up

Open the beamer view →

Host: starts the game and shows questions, answers, leaderboard

After each question: answer + explanation — the app does that.

► [Start timer](#)

Time

5m

2 — TOPIC

Watch how it works



Your mission:

1. Check your three quiz answers
2. Spot it: who checks whom?
3. Note what surprises you —
it feeds the discussion in a minute

► **easyvote — «Gewaltenteilung»** · video in German ·
1:24

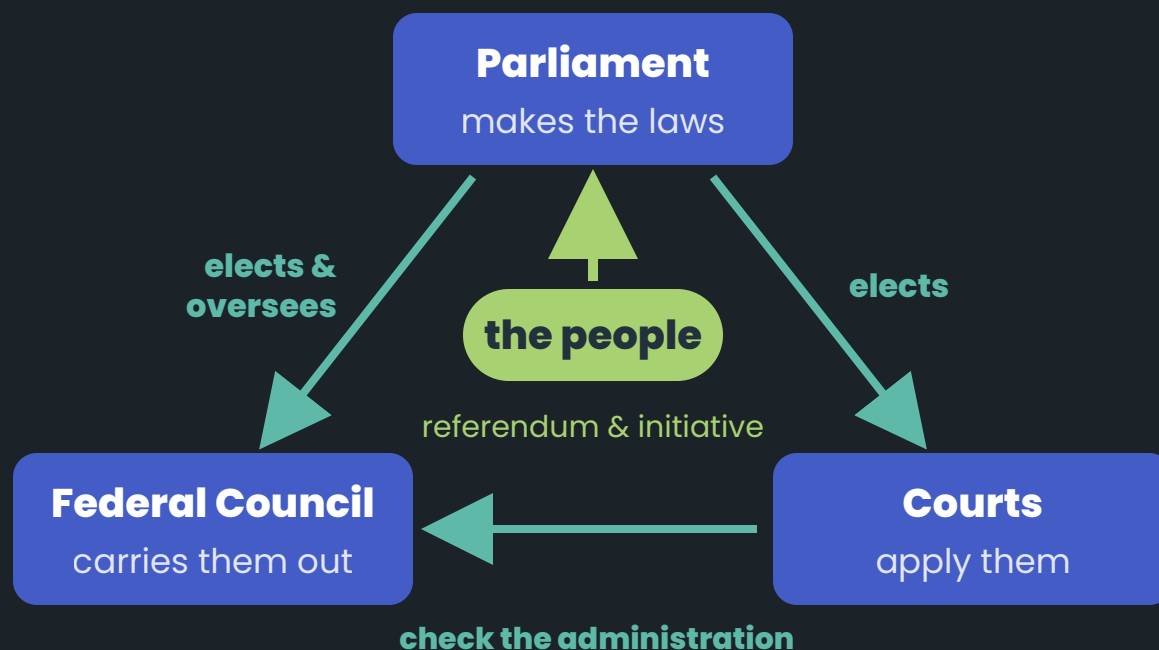
Backup: [SRF school — «3 Gewalten»](#)

To read: [ch.ch — Separation of powers](#)

The video says how — the why we settle ourselves.

2 — TOPIC • THE CHECK

Who checks whom?



The Federal Supreme Court must **apply** federal laws — it does not overturn them (Art. 190 Const.).

Nobody sends parliament home — **fixed four-year terms**.

The last check is **the people**: referendum & initiative.

Mission 2 solved — what surprised you?

3 — EXERCISE • DISCUSSION

But why, actually?

“Honestly: an autocracy is faster. One decision, no debate. Why do we afford this slow apparatus?”

2' in twos or threes: is the slow apparatus worth it — yes or no?

3' in the round: per group **one** strongest argument — for or against.

Moderation: cut hard after 2' — one argument per group, then move on.

Time

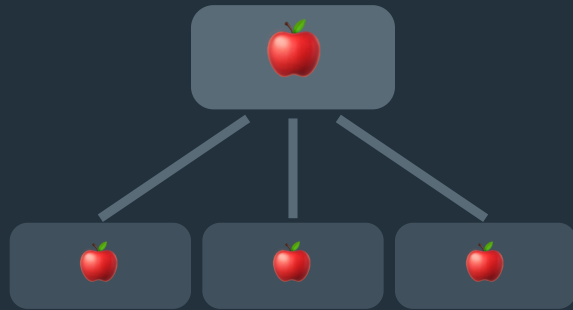
5m

[▶ Start timer](#)

3 — EXERCISE • THE REVEAL

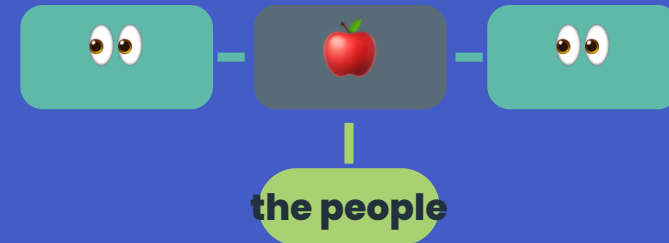
The rotten apple

Autocracy



The rotten apple sits at the top. Nobody may check it, nobody can replace it — the rot becomes the system.

Separation of powers



The rotten apple is seen: two branches and the people can stop and replace it. The damage stays local.

Brakes aren't there to drive slowly — they're there so you **can** drive fast.

Show only after the discussion — don't spoil it.

► Show as animation

4 — TAKE-AWAY · BOTTOM LINE ★

“Democracy? They’re all corrupt anyway.”



★ Claim your star now

Your kit for exactly that conversation:



That’s exactly why

Corruption needs unchecked power. Here everyone checks everyone — abuse gets expensive.



Nobody is both

Whoever makes laws doesn’t execute them and doesn’t judge them — one person, one branch.



You are the last resort

Referendum & initiative: in Switzerland even the people check the state.



Slow is the price of safe

Autocracy is faster — but only good as long as the power stays benevolent.

Bottom line → Master Checklist · Civics star ★ earned

Time

5m

Die Runde

DEMOCRACY MATTERS × DAY8

Merci!

The Learning Loop — design & concept of the gamified workshop
format: **DAY8 GmbH**



Slides, video, quiz & star — everything to revisit

tigerraph.github.io/dm-quiz/content/gewaltenteilung-ch.html

FOR THE MODERATOR

Run sheet

-
- 0'–5'** **Warm-up** — QR slide, **open the beamer view**, play the 3 questions. The app shows the explanations.
-
- 5'–15'** **Topic** — announce the mission, **easyvote video (1:24, German)** from the slide, then the check slide: walk the triangle, collect surprises. Backup: **SRF «3 Gewalten»**.
-
- 15'–20'** **Exercise** — why-discussion: 2' in twos/threes, then 3' round, **one** argument per group. Cut hard after 2'. **Only then** show the reveal: rotten apple + brakes line.
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- 20'–25'** **Take-away** — go through the skeptic kit, bottom line onto the Master Checklist, award the Civics star ★. Never cut.
-
- 25'–30'** **Buffer** — then transition into the round.
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Details: [docs/runbook-gewaltenteilung-ch.md](#) • **To revisit:** [.../content/gewaltenteilung-ch.html](#)